

## **Placement Experience**

**Name:** Raghav Swaminathan

**Roll Number:** 2018115083

**Company:** Searce Inc.

**Placement Rounds:** 4

**Job Role Offered:** Applied AI Consultant

### **Placement Experience in Detail:**

1. Round 1: Online Test (45 questions, 60 minutes)  
Had three sections – Quantitative, Logical and Data Analysis questions. The questions were pretty easy, just brush-up basic math concepts and you'll be able to ace the test. If you're someone who's preparing for GRE/GMAT/CAT, the questions would be more or less relatable.
2. Round 2 (1 hour): Core interview questions were more inclined towards Product Management/Business Analysis. I was also bombarded with various scenario-based questions. A few notable questions that I can recollect are:
  1. Tell us about yourself
  2. Online test experience and my rating on a scale of 1-10
  3. Hobbies and Leadership Experience
  4. Academic Projects Worked On
  5. Internships done and achievements
  6. An extended problem statement was given to me based on one of my internship projects, and I was asked to put myself in the shoes of a Product Manager, do a quick requirements analysis, build a solution from scratch, provide feasible features, how it would improve CX, and explain the relevance of those features in solving the problem (was cross-questioned, where I had to convince the interviewer why the features/solutions I suggested were more efficient in comparison to solutions that already exist)
  7. Potential Industries/Markets that any consulting company should target to solve more AI based problems for clients and why (don't just pick random industries. For instance, if you're picking the Healthcare or E-Commerce, try to pick a pre-existing problem in that industry and explain how there's scope for solving more business problems in that industry)
  8. Review of Searce Products in Cloud, AI, and Analytics
  9. What would I do if I just won a million dollar lottery – investment strategies and whether I would continue working (be as smart as you can in answering such a question, as its directly meant to test your character and the core competencies that you have mentioned on your resume)
  10. What technical skills I brought to the table and how they were relevant to the job role I was applying for
  11. Strengths and weaknesses
  12. Why I wanted to join Searce
  13. Questions I had for them (your chance to bombard them with all the questions you have about the job role, the company, the industries they cater, your interview performance, etc.)

3. Round 3 (1 hour): Technical Interview of sorts, where I was asked to talk more about my projects and internships. I was further asked to explain the algorithms I used for all my projects and was further questioned on the UX, usefulness, and deployment of all my technical projects. In the process, I was given a brief introduction to all the available job roles that were offered and constantly assessed if I was the right candidate. A few notable questions that were asked are as follows:
  1. Explain something about yourself not mentioned on your resume (this gives you a hint that you need to reserve 5-10% of your resume content for such buffer scenarios)
  2. Explain technical projects (I volunteered to be elaborate about the problem statement, existing problems, motivation, competitor analysis, SWOT analysis, technical approach, project outcome – PoC/Research Paper/Product/Prototype)
  3. Questioned about practicality of certain features in my projects, with comparison to real time applications such as Instagram, Facebook, Snap Chat and Reddit
  4. Given problem statements and was asked ML solutions along with the algorithms I'd use and why I picked the approach I proposed
  5. Opinions on whether I would charge customers for any kind of paid service on social media, why I would do so, examples of real-time scenarios and the kind of paid services model I'd develop for content/software based on a B2C model
  6. Justify why I was the right fit for a consulting role
  7. Was asked certain technical concepts that were used in their products
  8. Current Searce products were explained to me, and I was asked for product reviews based on what I understood and my feedback on the method that they used to approach the same
  9. Opinions on whether I would pursue my hobbies as a professional interest and was asked to justify the same
  10. At the end, I voluntarily asked for feedback on my interview and loopholes on my resume – very useful in building a rapport with your interviewer as a future industry acquaintance/contact
4. Round 4 (20 minutes): This was the final interview round for me, (though a lot of other selects has a 5<sup>th</sup> round too) and it was a HR discussion. I was asked to talk about my character, my vision, what I intend to achieve at Searce, why I would want to join Searce and what made me choose the role I opted for (considering my technical background). I was finally offered the job, and we further went on to discuss my career growth at Searce, how Searce evolved to what it is today and what the daily work life of a Searcean would be like. The interview ended with me being asked my preferred job location and being informed that we'd be notified soon about our offer letters.

**Overall Experience:** It was a unique interviewing experience, with comparatively longer interviews (probably because of the job role). My interviewers were very chill, friendly and were acceptive towards constructive criticism from my end. My advice to those sitting for placements is not to worry or evidently show that you're nervous. Interviews are just to get to know you better, it's not the end of the world. There is always a plethora of interviews lined up for students. Also, while being confident, if you don't know something, accept the same with pride along with explaining how you'd work towards filling in the gaps, as it's your chance during the interview to learn something awesome from someone with real-time industry experience. Finally, do note that you might be the best at something. However, never let your ego get the better of you during an interview. Your aim is not to just tell interviewers that you're the best, but your aim has to be to prove it to them and make them understand why you're the best and the kind of an asset they'd miss if they don't pick you.

